Labelling Machine



Category: **Retail, Logistics & Warehouse** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 5 labs

Covers these lab items: Labeling Machine or Tag Gun; Labelling machines

What it is used for

A labelling machine prints, applies, or attaches labels to products, packages, or containers for identification and tracking. Correct setup, label verification, and safe operation help maintain readable information and consistent placement.

Main parts

- Label roll or label magazine supplies labels to the machine.
- Feed mechanism moves labels or products through the machine.
- Print head or printing unit prints variable information on applicable models.
- Applicator or dispensing mechanism attaches labels to products or packages.
- Control panel sets label format, speed, and operating options.
- Sensors detect labels or product position on equipped models.
- Guarding and emergency stop controls help protect the operator.
- Power supply or drive system operates the machine.

Before you start

1. Read the operating manual and confirm the machine is suitable for the label and product.
2. Inspect the power cable, guards, rollers, applicator, and emergency stop for damage.
3. Check label size, adhesive type, print quality requirements, and roll direction.
4. Verify the correct product information, batch details, date, and barcode where applicable.
5. Load compatible labels and approved ink or ribbon if required by the machine.
6. Clear the work area and keep hands, loose clothing, and tools away from moving parts.

How to use

1. Switch off the machine before loading labels, ink, ribbon, or making adjustments.
2. Install the label roll according to the feed diagram and secure the roll holder.
3. Thread the label material through the guides and sensors as instructed.
4. Enter or select the approved label layout and verify all printed information.
5. Set the label position, feed rate, and application settings for the product.
6. Run a test label or a small trial batch before full production.
7. Check that labels are readable, correctly positioned, and firmly attached.
8. Start production and monitor label feed, print quality, and product alignment.
9. Stop the machine before clearing a jam or correcting a misfeed.
10. At the end of the task, switch off the machine, remove waste labels, and record any faults.

⚠ Safety

- Keep fingers away from rollers, cutters, applicators, and other moving parts.
- Never bypass guards or disable the emergency stop.
- Isolate power before clearing jams, cleaning internal parts, or performing maintenance.
- Use only approved ink, ribbon, labels, and cleaning materials for the machine.
- Clean adhesive spills promptly using the recommended method and avoid skin or eye contact with chemicals.
- Follow safe lifting practices when handling heavy label rolls or product cartons.

Care & storage

- Clean print heads, sensors, rollers, and label paths according to the manual.
- Remove adhesive residue using approved cleaning materials only.
- Inspect belts, rollers, guards, and label guides regularly for wear or damage.
- Store unused labels, ink, and ribbon in clean, dry conditions.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Loading the label roll in the wrong direction.
- Printing incorrect product, batch, date, or barcode information.
- Starting full production without checking a test label.
- Clearing a label jam while the machine is running or powered.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.